

views::concat

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§ 1 Revision History

§ 1.1 R2

- Adding extra semantic constraints in the concept `concat-indirectly-readable` to prevent non-equality-preserving behaviour of `operator*` and `iter_move`.

§ 1.2 R1

- Removed the `common_range` support for underlying ranges that are `!common_range` && `random_access_range` && `sized_range`.
- Introduced extra exposition concepts to simplify the wording that defines `concatable`.

§ 2 Abstract

This paper proposes `views::concat` as very briefly introduced in Section 4.7 of [P2214R1]. It is a view factory that takes an arbitrary number of ranges as an argument list, and provides a view that starts at the first element of the first range, ends at the last element of the last range, with all range elements sequenced in between respectively in the order given in the arguments, effectively concatenating, or chaining together the argument ranges.

§ 3 Motivation and Examples

Before	After
<pre>std::vector<int> v1{1,2,3}, v2{4,5}, v3{}; std::array a{6,7,8}; int s = 9; std::cout << std::format("[{:n}, {:n}, {:n}, {:n}, {}]\n", v1, v2, v3, a, s); // output: [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, , 6, 7, 8, 9]</pre>	<pre>std::vector<int> v1{1,2,3}, v2{4,5}, v3{}; std::array a{6,7,8}; auto s = std::views::single(9); std::cout << std::format("{}\n", std::views::concat(v1, v2, v3, a, s)); // output: [1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9]</pre>
<pre>class Foo; class Bar{ public: const Foo& getFoo() const; }; class MyClass{ std::vector<Foo> foos_; Bar bar_; public: auto getFoos () const{ std::vector<std::reference_wrapper<Foo> const>> fooRefs; fooRefs.reserve(foos_.size() + 1);</pre>	<pre>class Foo; class Bar{ public: const Foo& getFoo() const; }; class MyClass{ std::vector<Foo> foos_; Bar bar_; public: auto getFoos () const{ return std::views::concat(foos_, std::views::single(std::cref(bar_))</pre>

Before	After
<pre> for (auto const& f : foos_) { fooRefs.emplace_back(f); } fooRefs.emplace_back(bar_.getFoo()); return fooRefs; } }; // user for(const auto& foo: myClass.getFoos()){ // `foo` is std::reference_wrapper<Foo // const>, not simply a Foo // ... } </pre>	<pre> std::views::transform(&Bar::getFoo)); }; }; // user for(const auto& foo: myClass.getFoos()){ // use foo, which is Foo const & } </pre>

The first example shows that dealing with multiple ranges require care even in the simplest of cases: The “Before” version manually concatenates all the ranges in a formatting string, but empty ranges aren’t handled and the result contains an extra comma and a space. With `concat_view`, empty ranges are handled per design, and the construct expresses the intent cleanly and directly.

In the second example, the user has a class composed of fragmented and indirect data. They want to implement a member function that provides a range-like view to all this data sequenced together in some order, and without creating any copies. The “Before” implementation is needlessly complex and creates a temporary container with a potentially problematic indirection in its value type. `concat_view` based implementation is a neat one-liner.

§ 4 Design

This is a generator factory as described in [P2214R1] Section 4.7. As such, it can not be piped to. It takes the list of ranges to concatenate as arguments to `ranges::concat_view` constructor, or to `ranges::views::concat` customization point object.

§ 4.1 concatable-ity of ranges

Adaptability of any given two or more distinct ranges into a sequence that itself models a range, depends on the compatibility of the reference and the value types of these ranges. A precise formulation is made in terms of `std::common_reference_t` and `std::common_type_t`, and is captured by the exposition only concept `concatable`. See [Wording](#). Proposed `concat_view` is then additionally constrained by this concept. (Note that, this is an improvement over [range-v3] `concat_view` which lacks such constraints, and fails with hard errors instead.)

§ 4.1.1 reference

The reference type is the `common_reference_t` of all underlying range’s `range_reference_t`. In addition, as the result of `common_reference_t` is not necessarily a reference type, an extra constraint is needed to make sure that each underlying range’s `range_reference_t` is convertible to that common reference.

§ 4.1.2 value_type

To support the cases where underlying ranges have proxy iterators, such as `zip_view`, the `value_type` cannot simply be the `remove_cvref_t` of the reference type, and it needs to respect underlying ranges’

value_type. Therefore, in this proposal the value_type is defined as the common_type_t of all underlying range's range_value_t.

§ 4.1.3 range_rvalue_reference_t

To make concat_view's iterator's iter_move behave correctly for the cases where underlying iterators customise iter_move, such as zip_view, concat_view has to respect those customizations. Therefore, concat_view requires common_reference_t of all underlying ranges's range_rvalue_reference_t exist and can be converted to from each underlying range's range_rvalue_reference_t.

§ 4.1.4 indirectly_readable

In order to make concat_view model input_range, reference, value_type, and range_rvalue_reference_t have to be constrained so that the iterator of the concat_view models indirectly_readable.

§ 4.1.5 Mixing ranges of references with ranges of prvalues

In the following example,

```
std::vector<std::string> v = ...;
auto r1 = v | std::views::transform([](auto&& s) -> std::string&& {return
    std::move(s);});
auto r2 = std::views::iota(0, 2)
    | std::views::transform([](auto i){return std::to_string(i)});
auto cv = std::views::concat(r1, r2);
auto it = cv.begin();
*it; // first deref
*it; // second deref
```

r1 is a range of which range_reference_t is std::string&&, while r2's range_reference_t is std::string. The common_reference_t between these two references would be std::string. After the “first deref”, even though the result is unused, there is a conversion from std::string&& to std::string when the result of underlying iterator's operator* is converted to the common_reference_t. This is a move construction and the underlying vector's element is modified to a moved-from state. Later when the “second deref” is called, the result is a moved-from std::string. This breaks the “equality preserving” requirements.

Similar to operator*, ranges::iter_move has this same issue, and it is more common to run into this problem. For example,

```
std::vector<std::string> v = ...;
auto r = std::views::iota(0, 2)
    | std::views::transform([](auto i){return std::to_string(i)});
auto cv = std::views::concat(v, r);
auto it = cv.begin();
std::ranges::iter_move(it); // first iter_move
std::ranges::iter_move(it); // second iter_move
```

v's range_rvalue_reference_t is std::string&&, and r's range_rvalue_reference_t is std::string, the common_reference_t between them is std::string. After the first iter_move, the underlying vector's first element is moved to construct the temporary common_reference_t, aka std::string. As a result, the second iter_move results in a moved-from state std::string. This breaks the “non-modifying” equality-preserving contract in indirectly_readable concept.

A naive solution for this problem is to ban all the usages of mixing ranges of references with ranges of prvalues. However, not all of this kind of mixing are problematic. For example, concating a range of

`std::string&&` with a range of prvalue `std::string_view` is OK, because converting `std::string&&` to `std::string_view` does not modify the `std::string&&`. In general, it is not possible to detect whether the conversion from $T\&$ to U modifies $T\&$ through syntactic requirements. Therefore, the authors of this paper propose to use the “equality-preserving” semantic requirements of the `requires-expression` and the notational convention that constant lvalues shall not be modified in a manner observable to equality-preserving as defined in 18.2 [concepts.equality]. See [Wording](#).

§ 4.1.6 Unsupported Cases and Potential Extensions for the Future

Common type and reference based concatable logic is a practical and convenient solution that satisfies the motivation as outlined, and is what the authors propose in this paper. However, there are several potentially important use cases that get left out:

1. Concatenating ranges of different subclasses, into a range of their common base.
2. Concatenating ranges of unrelated types into a range of a user-determined common type, e.g. a `std::variant`.

Here is an example of the first case where `common_reference` formulation can manifest a rather counter-intuitive behavior: Let `D1` and `D2` be two types only related by their common base `B`, and `d1`, `d2`, and `b` be some range of these types, respectively. `concat(b, d1, d2)` is a well-formed range of `B` by the current formulation, suggesting such usage is supported. However, a mere reordering of the sequence, say to `concat(d1, d2, b)`, yields one that is not.

The authors believe that such cases should be supported, but can only be done so via an adaptor that needs at least one explicit type argument at its interface. A future extension may satisfy these use cases, for example a `concat_as` view, or by even generally via an `as` view that is a type-generalized version of the `as_const` view of [P2278R1].

§ 4.2 Zero or one view

- No argument `views::concat()` is ill-formed. It can not be a `views::empty<T>` because there is no reasonable way to determine an element type T .
- Single argument `views::concat(r)` is expression equivalent to `views::all(r)`, which intuitively follows.

§ 4.3 Hidden $O(N)$ time complexity for N adapted ranges

Time complexities as required by the ranges concepts are formally expressed with respect to the total number of elements (the size) of a given range, and not to the statically known parameters of that range. Hence, the complexity of `concat_view` or its iterators’ operations are documented to be constant time, even though some of these are a linear function of the number of ranges it concatenates which is a statically known parameter of this view.

Some examples of these operations for `concat_view` are `copy`, `begin` and `size`, and its iterators’ `increment`, `decrement`, `advance`, `distance`. This characteristic (but not necessarily the specifics) are very much similar to the other n -ary adaptors like `zip_view` [P2321R2] and `cartesian_view` [P2374R3].

§ 4.4 Borrowed vs Cheap Iterator

`concat_view` can be designed to be a `borrowed_range`, if all the underlying ranges are. However, this requires the iterator implementation to contain a copy of all iterators and sentinels of all underlying ranges at all times (just like that of `views::zip` [P2321R2]). On the other hand (unlike `views::zip`), a much cheaper implementation can satisfy all the proposed functionality provided it is permitted to be

unconditionally not borrowed. This implementation would maintain only a single active iterator at a time and simply refers to the parent view for the bounds.

Experience shows the borrowed-ness of `concat` is not a major requirement; and the existing implementation in [\[range-v3\]](#) seems to have picked the cheaper alternative. This paper proposes the same.

§ 4.5 Common Range

`concat_view` can be `common_range` if the last underlying range models `common_range`

§ 4.6 Bidirectional Range

`concat_view` can model `bidirectional_range` if the underlying ranges satisfy the following conditions:

- Every underlying range models `bidirectional_range`
- If the iterator is at *n*th range's begin position, after `operator--` it should go to (*n*-1)th's range's end-1 position. This means, the (*n*-1)th range has to support either
 - `common_range` && `bidirectional_range`, so the position can be reached by `--ranges::end(n-1th range)`, assuming *n*-1th range is not empty, or
 - `random_access_range` && `sized_range`, so the position can be reached by `ranges::begin(n-1th range) + (ranges::size(n-1th range) - 1)` in constant time, assuming *n*-1th range is not empty.

Note that the last underlying range does not have to satisfy this constraint because *n*-1 can never be the last underlying range. If neither of the two constraints is satisfied, in theory we can cache the end-1 position for every single underlying range inside the `concat_view` itself. But the authors do not consider this type of ranges as worth supporting `bidirectional`

In the `concat` implementation in [\[range-v3\]](#), `operator--` is only constrained on all underlying ranges being `bidirectional_range` on the declaration, but its implementation is using `ranges::next(ranges::begin(r), ranges::end(r))` which implicitly requires random access to make the operation constant time. So it went with the second constraint. In this paper, both are supported.

§ 4.7 Random Access Range

`concat_view` can be `random_access_range` if all the underlying ranges model `random_access_range` and `sized_range`.

§ 4.8 Sized Range

`concat_view` can be `sized_range` if all the underlying ranges model `sized_range`

§ 4.9 Implementation experience

`views::concat` has been implemented in [\[range-v3\]](#), with equivalent semantics as proposed here. The authors also implemented a version that directly follows the proposed wording below without any issue [\[ours\]](#).

§ 5 Wording

§ 5.1 Addition to `<ranges>`

Add the following to 26.2 [\[ranges.syn\]](#), header `<ranges>` synopsis:

```
// [...]
namespace std::ranges {
    // [...]

    // [range.concat], concat view
    template <input_range... Views>
        requires see below
    class concat_view;

    namespace views {
        inline constexpr unspecified concat = unspecified;
    }
}
```

§ 5.2 Range adaptor helpers [\[range.adaptor.helpers\]](#)

This paper applies the same following changes as in [\[P2374R3\]](#). If [\[P2374R3\]](#) is merged into the standard, the changes in this section can be dropped.

New section after Non-propagating cache 26.7.4 [\[range.nonprop.cache\]](#). Move the definitions of *tuple-or-pair*, *tuple-transform*, and *tuple-for-each* from Class template *zip_view* 26.7.20.2 [\[range.zip.view\]](#) to this section:

```
namespace std::ranges {
    template <class... Ts>
        using tuple-or-pair = see below; // exposition only

    template<class F, class Tuple>
    constexpr auto tuple-transform(F&& f, Tuple&& tuple) { // exposition only
        return apply([&<class... Ts>(Ts&&... elements) {
            return tuple-or-pair<invoke_result_t<F&, Ts>...>(
                invoke(f, std::forward<Ts>(elements))...
            );
        }, std::forward<Tuple>(tuple));
    }

    template<class F, class Tuple>
    constexpr void tuple-for-each(F&& f, Tuple&& tuple) { // exposition only
        apply([&<class... Ts>(Ts&&... elements) {
            (invoke(f, std::forward<Ts>(elements)), ...);
        }, std::forward<Tuple>(tuple));
    }
}
```

Given some pack of types *Ts*, the alias template *tuple-or-pair* is defined as follows:

1. If `sizeof...(Ts)` is 2, *tuple-or-pair*<*Ts*...> denotes *pair*<*Ts*...>.
2. Otherwise, *tuple-or-pair*<*Ts*...> denotes *tuple*<*Ts*...>.

§ 5.3 concat

Add the following subclause to 26.7 [\[range.adaptors\]](#).

§ 24.7.? Concat view [\[range.concat\]](#)

§ 24.7?.1 Overview [\[range.concat.overview\]](#)

- 1 `concat_view` presents a view that concatenates all the underlying ranges.
- 2 The name `views::concat` denotes a customization point object (16.3.3.3.6 [\[customization.point.object\]](#)). Given a pack of subexpressions `Es...`, the expression `views::concat(Es...)` is expression-equivalent to
 - (2.1) — `views::all(Es...)` if `Es` is a pack with only one element and `views::all(Es...)` is a well formed expression,
 - (2.2) — otherwise, `concat_view(Es...)` if this expression is well formed,
 - (2.3) — otherwise, ill-formed.

[Example:

```
std::vector<int> v1{1,2,3}, v2{4,5}, v3{};
std::array a{6,7,8};
auto s = std::views::single(9);
for(auto&& i : std::views::concat(v1, v2, v3, a, s)){
    std::cout << i << ' '; // prints: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9
}
```

— end example]

§ 24.7.?.2 Class template `concat_view` [\[range.concat.view\]](#)

```
namespace std::ranges {

    template <class... Rs>
    using concat-reference-t = common_reference_t<range_reference_t<Rs>...>; // exposition
                                only

    template <class... Rs>
    using concat-value-t = common_type_t<range_value_t<Rs>...>; // exposition only

    template <class... Rs>
    using concat-rvalue-reference-t = common_reference_t<range_rvalue_reference_t<Rs>...>;
                                // exposition only

    template <class... Rs>
    concept concat-indirectly-readable = see below; // exposition only

    template <class... Rs>
    concept concatable = see below; // exposition only

    template <class... Rs>
    concept concat-random-access = // exposition only
        ((random_access_range<Rs> && sized_range<Rs>)&&...);

    template <class R>
    concept constant-time-reversible = // exposition only
        (bidirectional_range<R> && common_range<R>) ||
        (sized_range<R> && random_access_range<R>);

    template <class... Rs>
    concept concat-bidirectional = see below; // exposition only

    template <input_range... Views>
    requires (view<Views> && ...) && (sizeof...(Views) > 0) &&
        concatable<Views...>
    class concat_view : public view_interface<concat_view<Views...>> {
        tuple<Views...> views_ = tuple<Views...>(); // exposition only

    public:
        template <bool Const>
        class iterator; // exposition only
    };
}
```



```

public:
    constexpr concat_view() requires(default_initializable<Views>&&...) = default;

    constexpr explicit concat_view(Views... views);

    constexpr iterator<false> begin() requires(!(simple-view<Views> && ...));

    constexpr iterator<true> begin() const
        requires((range<const Views> && ...) && concatable<const Views...>);

    constexpr auto end() requires(!(simple-view<Views> && ...));

    constexpr auto end() const requires(range<const Views>&&...);

    constexpr auto size() requires(sized_range<Views>&&...);

    constexpr auto size() const requires(sized_range<const Views>&&...);
};

template <class... R>
    concat_view(R&&...) -> concat_view<views::all_t<R>...>;
}

```

```

template <class... Rs>
concept concat-indirectly-readable = see below;

```

- 1 The exposition-only *concat-indirectly-readable* concept is equivalent to:

```

template <class Ref, class RRef, class It>
concept concat-indirectly-readable-impl = requires (const It it){
    static_cast<Ref>(*it);
    static_cast<RRef>(ranges::iter_move(it));
};

template <class... Rs>
concept concat-indirectly-readable =
    common_reference_with<concat-reference-t<Rs...>&&,
                        concat-value-t<Rs...>&& &&
    common_reference_with<concat-reference-t<Rs...>&&,
                        concat-rvalue-reference-t<Rs...>&& &&
    common_reference_with<concat-rvalue-reference-t<Rs...>&&,
                        concat-value-t<Rs...> const&& &&
    (concat-indirectly-readable-impl<concat-reference-t<Rs...>,
     concat-rvalue-reference-t<Rs...>,
     iterator_t<Rs...> && ...);

```

```

template <class... Rs>
concept concatable = see below;

```

- 2 The exposition-only *concatable* concept is equivalent to:

```

template <class... Rs>
concept concatable = requires {
    typename concat-reference-t<Rs...>;
    typename concat-value-t<Rs...>;
    typename concat-rvalue-reference-t<Rs...>;
} && concat-indirectly-readable<Rs...>;

```

```

template <class... Rs>
concept concat-bidirectional = see below;

```

- 3 The pack *Rs...* models *concat-bidirectional* if,

- (3.1) — Last element of `Rs... models bidirectional_range`,
- (3.2) — And, all except the last element of `Rs... model constant-time-reversible`.

```
constexpr explicit concat_view(Views... views);
```

- 4 *Effects*: Initializes `views_` with `std::move(views)...`

```
constexpr iterator<false> begin() requires(!simple-view<Views> && ...);
constexpr iterator<true> begin() const
    requires((range<const Views> && ...) && concatable<const Views...>);
```

- 5 *Effects*: Let *is-const* be true for const-qualified overload, and false otherwise. Equivalent to:

```
iterator<is-const> it{this, in_place_index<0>, ranges::begin(get<0>(views_))};
it.template satisfy<0>();
return it;
```

```
constexpr auto end() requires(!simple-view<Views> && ...);
constexpr auto end() const requires(range<const Views>&&...);
```

- 6 *Effects*: Let *is-const* be true for const-qualified overload, and false otherwise, and let *last-view* be the last element of the pack `const Views...` for const-qualified overload, and the last element of the pack `Views...` otherwise. Equivalent to:

```
if constexpr (common_range<last-view>) {
    constexpr auto N = sizeof...(Views);
    return iterator<is-const>{this, in_place_index<N - 1>,
        ranges::end(get<N - 1>(views_))};
} else {
    return default_sentinel;
}
```

```
constexpr auto size() requires(sized_range<Views>&&...);
constexpr auto size() const requires(sized_range<const Views>&&...);
```

- 7 *Effects*: Equivalent to:

```
return apply(
    [](auto... sizes) {
        using CT = make_unsigned_t<common_type_t<decltype(sizes)...>>;
        return (CT{0} + ... + CT{sizes});
    },
    tuple_transform(ranges::size, views_));
```

§ 24.7.3 Class `concat_view::iterator` [range.concat.iterator]

```
namespace std::ranges{

    template <input_range... Views>
        requires (view<Views> && ...) && (sizeof...(Views) > 0) &&
            concatable<Views...>
    template <bool Const>
    class concat_view<Views...>::iterator {

    public:
        using value_type = common_type_t<range_value_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;
        using difference_type = common_type_t<range_difference_t<maybe-const<Const,
            Views>>...>;
        using iterator_concept = see below;
        using iterator_category = see below; // not always present.
```

```

private:
    using base-iter =                                // exposition only
        variant<iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

    maybe-const<Const, concat_view>* parent_ = nullptr; // exposition only
    base-iter it_ = base-iter();                       // exposition only

    friend class iterator<!Const>;
    friend class concat_view;

    template <std::size_t N>
    constexpr void satisfy();                          // exposition only

    template <std::size_t N>
    constexpr void prev();                             // exposition only

    template <std::size_t N>
    constexpr void advance-fwd(difference_type offset, difference_type steps); //
    // exposition only

    template <std::size_t N>
    constexpr void advance-bwd(difference_type offset, difference_type steps); //
    // exposition only

    template <class... Args>
    explicit constexpr iterator(
        maybe-const<Const, concat_view>* parent,
        Args&&... args)
        requires constructible_from<base-iter, Args&&...>; // exposition only

public:
    iterator() requires(default_initializable<iterator_t<maybe-const<Const,
Views>>>&&...>) =
    default;

    constexpr iterator(iterator<!Const> i)
        requires Const &&
        (convertible_to<iterator_t<Views>, iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

    constexpr decltype(auto) operator*() const;

    constexpr iterator& operator++();

    constexpr void operator++(int);

    constexpr iterator operator++(int)
        requires(forward_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>&&...>);

    constexpr iterator& operator--()
        requires concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;

    constexpr iterator operator--(int)
        requires concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>

    constexpr iterator& operator+=(difference_type n)
        requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;

    constexpr iterator& operator-=(difference_type n)
        requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;

    constexpr decltype(auto) operator[](difference_type n) const
        requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;

```

```

friend constexpr bool operator==(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(equality_comparable<iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

friend constexpr bool operator==(const iterator& it, default_sentinel_t);

friend constexpr bool operator<(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

friend constexpr bool operator>(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

friend constexpr bool operator<=(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

friend constexpr bool operator>=(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

friend constexpr auto operator<==(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires((random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&
        three_way_comparable<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>));

friend constexpr iterator operator+(const iterator& it, difference_type n)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr iterator operator+(difference_type n, const iterator& it)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr iterator operator-(const iterator& it, difference_type n)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr difference_type operator-(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr difference_type operator-(const iterator& x, default_sentinel_t)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr difference_type operator-(default_sentinel_t, const iterator& x)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>;

friend constexpr decltype(auto) iter_move(iterator const& it) noexcept(see below);

friend constexpr void iter_swap(const iterator& x, const iterator& y) noexcept(see
    below)
    requires see below;
};
}

```

¹ `iterator::iterator_concept` is defined as follows:

- (1.1) — If `concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>` is modeled, then `iterator_concept` denotes `random_access_iterator_tag`.
- (1.2) — Otherwise, if `concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>` is modeled, then `iterator_concept` denotes `bidirectional_iterator_tag`.
- (1.3) — Otherwise, if `(forward_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&& ...)` is modeled, then `iterator_concept` denotes `forward_iterator_tag`.
- (1.4) — Otherwise, `iterator_concept` denotes `input_iterator_tag`.

² The member typedef-name `iterator_category` is defined if and only if `(forward_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...)` is modeled. In that case, `iterator::iterator_category` is defined as

follows:

- (2.1) — If `is_lvalue_reference<reference>` is false, then `iterator_category` denotes `input_iterator_tag`
- (2.2) — Otherwise, let `Cs` denote the pack of types `iterator_traits<iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>::iterator_category...`
 - (2.2.1) — If `(derived_from<Cs, random_access_iterator_tag> && ...) && concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>` is true, `iterator_category` denotes `random_access_iterator_tag`.
 - (2.2.2) — If `(derived_from<Cs, bidirectional_iterator_tag> && ...) && concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>` is true, `iterator_category` denotes `bidirectional_iterator_tag`.
 - (2.2.3) — If `(derived_from<Cs, forward_iterator_tag> && ...)` is true, `iterator_category` denotes `forward_iterator_tag`.
 - (2.2.4) — Otherwise, `iterator_category` denotes `input_iterator_tag`.

```
template <std::size_t N>
constexpr void satisfy(); // exposition only
```

3 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
if constexpr (N != (sizeof...(Views) - 1)) {
    if (get<N>(it_) == ranges::end(get<N>(parent_->views_)) {
        it_.template emplace<N + 1>(ranges::begin(get<N + 1>(parent_->views_)));
        satisfy<N + 1>();
    }
}
```

```
template <std::size_t N>
constexpr void prev(); // exposition only
```

4 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
if constexpr (N == 0) {
    --get<0>(it_);
} else {
    if (get<N>(it_) == ranges::begin(get<N>(parent_->views_)) {
        using prev_view = maybe-const<Const, tuple_element_t<N - 1, tuple<Views...>>>;
        if constexpr (common_range<prev_view>) {
            it_.template emplace<N - 1>(ranges::end(get<N - 1>(parent_->views_)));
        } else {
            it_.template emplace<N - 1>(
                ranges::next(ranges::begin(get<N - 1>(parent_->views_)),
                    ranges::size(get<N - 1>(parent_->views_)));
        }
        prev<N - 1>();
    } else {
        --get<N>(it_);
    }
}
```

```
template <std::size_t N>
constexpr void advance_fwd(difference_type offset, difference_type steps); // exposition only
```

5 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```

if constexpr (N == sizeof...(Views) - 1) {
    get<N>(it_) += steps;
} else {
    auto n_size = ranges::size(get<N>(parent_>views_));
    if (offset + steps < static_cast<difference_type>(n_size)) {
        get<N>(it_) += steps;
    } else {
        it_.template emplace<N + 1>(ranges::begin(get<N + 1>(parent_>views_)));
        advance-fwd<N + 1>(0, offset + steps - n_size);
    }
}
}

```

```

template <std::size_t N>
constexpr void advance-bwd(difference_type offset, difference_type steps); // exposition
only

```

⁶ *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```

if constexpr (N == 0) {
    get<N>(it_) -= steps;
} else {
    if (offset >= steps) {
        get<N>(it_) -= steps;
    } else {
        it_.template emplace<N - 1>(ranges::begin(get<N - 1>(parent_>views_))
+
                                ranges::size(get<N - 1>(parent_>views_)));
        advance-bwd<N - 1>(
            static_cast<difference_type>(ranges::size(get<N - 1>(parent_>views_)),
            steps - offset);
    }
}
}

```

```

template <class... Args>
explicit constexpr iterator(
    maybe-const<Const, concat_view>* parent,
    Args&&... args)
requires constructible_from<base-iter, Args&&...>; // exposition only

```

⁷ *Effects:* Initializes *parent_* with *parent*, and initializes *it_* with `std::forward<Args>(args)...`

```

constexpr iterator(iterator<!Const> i)
requires Const &&
(convertible_to<iterator_t<Views>, iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);

```

⁸ *Effects:* Initializes *parent_* with *i.parent_*, and initializes *it_* with `std::move(i.it_)`.

```

constexpr decltype(auto) operator*() const;

```

⁹ *Preconditions:* *it_.valueless_by_exception()* is false.

¹⁰ *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```

using reference = common_reference_t<range_reference_t<maybe-const<Const,
Views>>...>;
return std::visit([](auto&& it) -> reference {
    return *it; }, it_);

```

```

constexpr iterator& operator++();

```

11 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

12 *Effects:* Let i be `it_.index()`. Equivalent to:

```
++get<i>(it_);  
satisfy<i>();  
return *this;
```

```
constexpr void operator++(int);
```

13 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

14 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
++*this;
```

```
constexpr iterator operator++(int)  
requires forward_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>&&...>;
```

15 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

16 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
auto tmp = *this;  
++*this;  
return tmp;
```

```
constexpr iterator& operator--()  
requires concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

17 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

18 *Effects:* Let i be `it_.index()`. Equivalent to:

```
prev<i>();  
return *this;
```

```
constexpr iterator operator--(int)  
requires concat-bidirectional<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>
```

19 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

20 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
auto tmp = *this;  
--*this;  
return tmp;
```

```
constexpr iterator& operator+=(difference_type n)  
requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

21 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

22 *Effects:* Let i be `it_.index()`. Equivalent to:

```
if(n > 0) {  
    advance-fwd<i>(get<i>(it_) - ranges::begin(get<i>(parent_->views_)), n);  
} else if (n < 0) {  
    advance-bwd<i>(get<i>(it_) - ranges::begin(get<i>(parent_->views_)), -n);  
}  
return *this;
```

```
constexpr iterator& operator-=(difference_type n)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

23 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

24 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
*this += -n;
return *this;
```

```
constexpr decltype(auto) operator[](difference_type n) const
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

25 *Preconditions:* `it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

26 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return *((*this) + n);
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator==(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(equality_comparable<iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);
```

27 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

28 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return x.it_ == y.it_;
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator==(const iterator& it, default_sentinel_t);
```

29 *Preconditions:* `it.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

30 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
constexpr auto last_idx = sizeof...(Views) - 1;
return it.it_.index() == last_idx &&
    get<last_idx>(it.it_) == ranges::end(get<last_idx>(it.parent_-
    >views_));
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator<(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);
```

31 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

32 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return x.it_ < y.it_;
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator>(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);
```

33 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

34 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return y < x;
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator<=(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>&&...>);
```


35 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

36 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return !(y < x);
```

```
friend constexpr bool operator>=(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires(random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>>&&...);
```

37 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

38 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return !(x < y);
```

```
friend constexpr auto operator<==(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires((random_access_range<maybe-const<Const, Views>> &&
        three_way_comparable<maybe-const<Const, Views>>&&...);
```

39 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

40 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return x.it_ <== y.it_;
```

```
friend constexpr iterator operator+(const iterator& it, difference_type n)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

41 *Preconditions:* `it.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

42 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return iterator{it} += n;
```

```
friend constexpr iterator operator+(difference_type n, const iterator& it)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

43 *Preconditions:* `it.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

44 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return it + n;
```

```
friend constexpr iterator operator-(const iterator& it, difference_type n)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

45 *Preconditions:* `it.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

46 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return iterator{it} -= n;
```

```
friend constexpr difference_type operator-(const iterator& x, const iterator& y)
    requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

47 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

48 *Effects:* Let i_x denote `x.it_.index()` and i_y denote `y.it_.index()`

- (48.1) — if $i_x > i_y$, let d_y denote the distance from `get< $i_y$ >(y.it_)` to the end of `get< $i_y$ >(y.parent_.views_)`, d_x denote the distance from the begin of `get< $i_x$ >(x.parent_.views_)` to `get< $i_x$ >(x.it_)`. For every integer $i_y < i < i_x$, let s denote the sum of the sizes of all the ranges `get< $i$ >(x.parent_.views_)` if there is any, and 0 otherwise, equivalent to

```
return  $d_y + s + d_x$ ;
```

- (48.2) — otherwise, if $i_x < i_y$, equivalent to:

```
return  $-(y - x)$ ;
```

- (48.3) — otherwise, equivalent to:

```
return get< $i_x$ >(x.it_) - get< $i_y$ >(y.it_);
```

```
friend constexpr difference_type operator-(const iterator& x, default_sentinel_t)
requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

- 49 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

- 50 *Effects:* Let i_x denote `x.it_.index()`, d_x denote the distance from `get< $i_x$ >(x.it_)` to the end of `get< $i_x$ >(x.parent_.views_)`. For every integer $i_x < i < \text{sizeof} \dots(\text{Views})$, let s denote the sum of the sizes of all the ranges `get< $i$ >(x.parent_.views_)` if there is any, and 0 otherwise, equivalent to

```
return  $-(d_x + s)$ ;
```

```
friend constexpr difference_type operator-(default_sentinel_t, const iterator& x)
requires concat-random-access<maybe-const<Const, Views>...>;
```

- 51 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

- 52 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return  $-(x - \text{default\_sentinel})$ ;
```

```
friend constexpr decltype(auto) iter_move(iterator const& it) noexcept(see below);
```

- 53 *Preconditions:* `it.it_.valueless_by_exception()` is false.

- 54 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
return std::visit(
    [](auto const& i) ->
        common_reference_t<range_rvalue_reference_t<maybe-const<Const,
Views>>...> {
        return ranges::iter_move(i);
    },
    it.it_);
```

- 55 *Remarks:* The exception specification is equivalent to:

```
((is_nothrow_invocable_v<decltype(ranges::iter_move),
    const iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>&& &&
    is_nothrow_convertible_v<range_rvalue_reference_t<maybe-const<Const,
Views>>,
    common_reference_t<range_rvalue_reference_t<
    maybe-const<Const, Views>>...>>) &&...)
```

```
friend constexpr void iter_swap(const iterator& x, const iterator& y) noexcept(see
    below)
    requires see below;
```

56 *Preconditions:* `x.it_.valueless_by_exception()` and `y.it_.valueless_by_exception()` are each false.

57 *Effects:* Equivalent to:

```
std::visit(ranges::iter_swap, x.it_, y.it_);
```

58 *Remarks:* The exception specification is true if and only if: For every combination of two types `X` and `Y` in the set of all types in the parameter pack `iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>...`, `is_nothrow_invocable_v<decltype(ranges::iter_swap), const X&, const Y&>` is true.

59 *Remarks:* The expression in the `requires`-clause is true if and only if: For every combination of two types `X` and `Y` in the set of all types in the parameter pack `iterator_t<maybe-const<Const, Views>>>...`, `indirectly_swappable<X, Y>` is modelled.

§ 5.4 Feature Test Macro

Add the following macro definition to 17.3.2 [version.syn], header `<version>` synopsis, with the value selected by the editor to reflect the date of adoption of this paper:

```
#define __cpp_lib_ranges_concat 20XXXXL // also in <ranges>
```

§ 6 References

[ours] Hui Xie and S. Levent Yilmaz. A proof-of-concept implementation of `views::concat`.
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[P2214R1] Barry Revzin, Conor Hoekstra, Tim Song. 2021-09-14. A Plan for C++23 Ranges.
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[P2321R2] Tim Song. 2021-06-11. zip.
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